Section 1. How This Plan Works

This Plan is a fee-for-service (FFS) plan. OPM requires that FEHB plans be accredited to validate that plan operations and/or care management meet nationally recognized standards. G.E.H.A holds the following accreditations: Health Plan Accreditation with Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care (AAAHC) and Dental Network Accreditation with URAC. To learn more about this plan's accreditations, please visit the following websites: Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care (www. aaahc.org); URAC (www. urac.org). You can choose your own physicians, facilities, and other healthcare providers. We give you a choice of enrollment in a High Option, a Standard Option, or a High Deductible (HDHP) Health Plan.

We reimburse you or your provider for your covered services, usually based on a percentage of the amount we allow. The type and extent of covered services, and the amount we allow, may be different from other plans. Read brochures carefully.

This Plan provides preventive services and screenings to you without any cost-sharing; you may choose any available primary care provider for adult and pediatric care, and visits for specialists do not require a referral.

General features of our High and Standard Option

We have a Preferred Providers Organization (PPO) Network

Our fee-for-service plan offers services through a PPO. This means that certain hospitals and other healthcare providers are "preferred providers". When you use our PPO providers, you will receive covered services at reduced cost. UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus network, which encompasses the UnitedHealthcare Select Plus network in California, is solely responsible for the selection of PPO providers in your area. Providers in the network accept a contracted payment from us, and you will only be responsible for your cost-sharing (copayments, coinsurance, deductibles, and non-covered services and supplies). You also have benefits to receive covered services from non-participating providers; however, out-of-network benefits may have higher out-of-pocket costs than the in-network benefits.

The Optum Transplant Network is the organ/tissue transplant network for all members.

To find in-network providers, use the provider search tool on the geha.com/Locate-Care website or call G.E.H.A at 800-821-6136. When you call your provider for an appointment, please remember to verify that the physician is still an in-network provider. G.E.H.A in-network providers are required to meet licensure and certification standards established by State and Federal authorities, however, inclusion in the network does not represent a guarantee of professional performance nor does it constitute medical advice.

You always have the right to choose an in-network provider or an out-of-network provider for medical treatment. When you see a provider not in the UHC Choice Plus network, G.E.H.A will pay at the out-of-network level, and you will pay a higher percentage of the cost.

The out-of-network benefits are the standard benefits of this Plan. In-network benefits apply only when you use an in-network provider. Provider networks may be more extensive in some areas than others. We cannot guarantee the availability of every specialty in all areas. If no in-network provider is available, or you do not use an in-network provider, the standard out-of-network benefits apply. However, if the services are rendered at an in-network facility, the professionals who provide services to you may not all be preferred providers. If the services are rendered by out-of-network providers at an in-network facility, we will pay up to the Plan allowance according to the No Surprises Act.

Note: Members residing outside the United States and accessing providers within their area of residence without access to an in-network providers, providers will be paid at the in-network level of benefits.

How we pay providers

Fee-for-service plans reimburse you or your provider for covered services. They do not typically provide or arrange for healthcare. Fee-for-service plans let you choose your own physicians, facilities and other healthcare providers.

The FFS plan reimburses you for your healthcare expenses, usually on a percentage basis. These percentages, as well as deductibles, methods for applying deductibles to families and the percentage of coinsurance you must pay vary by plan.